

Corn Disease: Gray Leaf Spot

Metadata

Crop: Corn
Disease: Gray Leaf Spot
Scientific Name: *Cercospora zeae-maydis*
Pathogen: Fungus
Source: TNAU Agritech Portal, FAO

Overview

Gray Leaf Spot is a fungal disease affecting maize leaves, reducing photosynthesis and leading to yield loss under humid conditions.

Symptoms

Early: Small tan spots that expand gradually.

Advanced: Long rectangular gray lesions bounded by veins, merging into large necrotic areas.

Similar Diseases

Northern Leaf Blight: cigar-shaped lesions.
Common Rust: orange raised pustules.

Favorable Conditions

High humidity (>90%), warm temperatures (20–30°C), dense planting, poor airflow.

Transmission

Airborne spores, survives in crop residue, spreads via wind and rain.

Management

Cultural: Crop rotation, residue removal, spacing.

Chemical: Fungicides such as strobilurins or triazoles.

Prevention

Resistant varieties, avoid monocropping, balanced fertilization, monitoring.

Severity

Mild: few lesions.

Moderate: reduced leaf area.

Severe: major leaf death and yield loss.

Recommended Action

Apply fungicides early and improve field conditions through rotation and monitoring.

Source

TNAU: <https://agritech.tnau.ac.in>

FAO: <https://www.fao.org>